

largest emerging market for Krafton. Although it's not as big as China, Korea, or the US, it's getting closer in terms of revenue contribution. Obviously, the gaming market in India is much smaller than in those countries, but it's growing faster.

What we have learned from the India market can be more or less applicable to other emerging markets like South America or maybe Africa in the next five to ten years.

One ambition I have is that because we have started publishing Real Cricket, we want to do more with Real Cricket – or future cricket games from Nautilus – outside India. Krafton has a certain capacity. We have already started on this front, and we will do more.

Are there lessons Indian regulators can learn about gaming policy?

Sean Sohn: The good thing is, as far as I have experienced, most – if not all – bureaucrats I have interacted with are very keen on learning from other countries: how they supported and nurtured the gaming industry, how they regulated in the right manner, and what lessons they learned from earlier experiences.

As a global company, we can share not just desktop research; we have our own experience in Korea, maybe in China, and also in the US. So we share our knowledge and understanding with those bureaucrats, and they are happy and appreciative.

It's not going to happen in a month or two – it's an ongoing process – but I think it's moving in the right direction.

Why is ecosystem investment so important for Krafton – and for the future of Indian gaming?

Sean Sohn: As a company, you cannot really grow by yourself; you grow with the industry, and you grow with the ecosystem. We think we can grow faster, and in a better direction, if we focus on ecosystem-

building and partnerships within the industry, with other industries, and with regulators. We learned that from past experience, and we are trying to do it right as we grow in an emerging market like India.

What is your optimistic vision of Indian gaming for 2026-27, and where do you see Krafton's position in that story?

Sean Sohn: People within the industry have optimism mixed with a conservative view, because of the RMG ban. The nominal size of the gaming industry has fallen by maybe one third, which is discouraging.

But in an optimistic scenario, people will find ways to absorb talent – the strong talent pool that has been produced from RMG and other parts of the industry. Smart people can make something out of this transition or confusion. So in the optimistic scenario, we will probably see new games or new companies that can

make decent money or deliver meaningful results out of this.

Any message to young Indians or concerned parents who are worried about their kids entering the Indian gaming ecosystem?

Sean Sohn: You have to judge whether a trend is a mainstream trend that will last for the long term. And I think gaming – and maybe something like AI – is a trend you cannot avoid. You have to embrace it, and for your kids or for yourself, you have to think about how you can navigate and actually exploit this change.

Gaming, especially mobile gaming, is going to be there for the rest of your life. Ideally, it can be one of the career options for yourself or for your kids, if they have interest.

As a parent, you should find your share of mind to do it. I'm also trying my best. 

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In India, the mature generation is afraid of gaming rather than trying to find ways to balance gaming and other parts of life. Personally, I'm trying my best, and I share my ideas on how to do it as a parent.

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